

Lil' Shmoogy



The Legend of Balinese DonMu – Book One (Part I of III) – Chapter 13

“... ok cool. But I will concede that a lot of people do use good causes for their own personal gain which can oftentimes give the whole movement a bad look. And that’s exactly what this girl has done. She’s sued every single company she’s ever worked for for racial discrimination and sexual harassment when I know for a fact that wasn’t the case. And that’s why I want to bring her into your ruse. To see justice done. Or karma. And make her see the other side of things and walk a mile in those shoes. And stop giving good people – and good causes – such a bad look.”

I squinted my eyes at her.

“So who is she Lakeisha? And is she here in Bali?”

“Yeah, she’s here. Down in Canggu. And she doesn’t know me so it’s perfect. And her name is ... well she’s a rapper now ... so her ‘stage name’ is ...”

“What stage name?” Wing interrupted.

Lakeisha hesitated. Trying to figure out how to best explain that to him.

“Well, you know how a lot of rappers change their names into – stage names – to create different personas for themselves? Like Lil’ Kim, Megan Thee Stallion, Doja Cat, BootyChaaain, Gangsta Boo, Lil Mama, Junglepussy, Lil Kimchii. Well ... I’m actually kinda embarrassed to say this, but this girl’s name is Lil’ Shmoogy.”

“Lil’ Shmoogy?” I said. “That sounds kinda racist?”

“Yeah, no shit.” She answered. “But technically the way she spells it isn’t racist. It’s just close to an old racist word. And apparently she didn’t know it at the time and when she found out about it, or someone told her about it, it was too late. She’d already amassed a bunch of followers and had her brand established so didn’t want to change it.”

I sat there puzzled.

“Wow, so she chose social-media followers and brand recognition over propagating racism?”

Olof spit out his drink.

“Yeah.” Lakeisha said. “I know. But again, technically the way she spells it isn’t racist. The word’s not in Webster’s but Urban Dictionary defines it as ... ‘a short, cuddly person who smells nice’ ... and I think one of her boyfriends used to call her, his ‘Lil’ Shmoogy’, so I think that’s how it all started.”

Wing then opened up his laptop and started a search. Poking away at his keyboard. Scrolling through some web pages. “Yup. Here it is.” He said staring at the screen. “Urban Dictionary says... ‘a small cuddly person, typically very lovable and nice smelling.’”

Lakeisha then turned to him. "Now spell it with a 'w' after the 'Sh'".

He resumed poking away. Clicking his little fingers. Mouth somewhat puckered up. Then stopped. And his eyes got wide. "Oooohhh, yeah ... now it racist."

"Yup." She said shaking her head.

I thought about that. Wondering about it all. And how it actually went for Lil' Shmoogy. And wanted to be fair about it all and walk a mile in her shoes like I did with Karen and the others. And look at things from her perspective. Because I really did like a lot of those rapper names. They were pretty awesome. And apparently she was called that name lovingly by her boyfriend, which made total sense for her to want to use it for her stage name. And then a year later, or whatever it was, someone came up to her and told her it was racist. I mean that's got to be a tough situation to find yourself in. When everything's going great, you're amassing a bunch of followers on Instagram, YouTube and TikTok, building your brand, getting name recognition, then all of a sudden someone comes up to you and says ...

"Hey, Lil' Shmoogy?"

And Lil' Shmoogy peers back up from behind her dark sunglasses and tough no-nonsense rapper persona.

"Yo. Sup."

"Did you know your stage-name is incredibly racist?"

She then stops and wrinkles her brow. "Thaaaa fuck you talking 'bout?"

"Yeah, it sounds and is spelled incredibly-close to an old racist word that was used back in the 70's."

Now there's some confusion. "Say whaaaaat?"

"Yeah, look it up."

Lil' Shmoogy now gives off a slightly-annoyed look and opens up her laptop ... typing away ... grumbling under her breath. Then stops. And her eyes get wide.

"Muthafuckin' whaaaaattt?!" Expression now changing. "Goddammit!!" Slamming the top of her laptop back down. "How tha' fuck am I supposed to know every racist word these goddamn cracka's been calling us for centuries?!"

"Yeah, you should probably change it since you don't want to be propagating that kind of racist stereotype?"

"Fuck yeah, I'm gonna change it! Don't want these cracka's thinking I'm some kind of joke or something like that. Fuuuuuuuck that shit!"

"Yeah, I agree. And this can be a great way to start over again and re-brand and re-build."

Lil' Shmoogy now scrunches her face up.

"What the fuck you talking about re-brand and re-build?"

"Well, you're going to have to delete all your social media accounts and start over again cause you don't want your current racist name up there."

"But what about all my followers, branding and merchandise?"

"Well, that's part of the beauty of starting over."

"So, I lose 'em all?"

"Yup."

"Fuuuuuuuuuck that shit!! I got a shit-ton of followers on Insta and a garage full of t-shirts I'm trying to sell. What am I supposed to do just throw 'em away?"

"But what about combating racism and people thinking you're some kind of joke?"

"Well, what the fuck are they gonna think if I change it now?! They'll think I'm some kind of dumbass who didn't know it was racist and had to change it. And what the fuck will that say

about me? Probably something worse. So, fuuuuuck that shit. I'm sticking with my original name. No one knows or uses that word anyway, so fuck it. I'm going Ride or Die with that shit ... Google me bitch, it ain't racist!"